

Grade	1	Word Count	249
Lexile	460L	Multi-level	N/A
Learning A–Z	level I		

Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

In **We Make Maple Syrup**, students learn the steps for making syrup from maple sap. From tapping the maple tree to eating the syrup on pancakes, students see how one family spends time together.

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We Make Maple Syrup



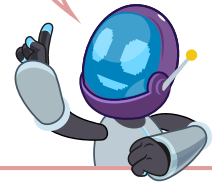
Written by Karen Mockler
Illustrated by Linda Pierce

We Make Maple Syrup



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Focus Question
Why is it important
to be patient?



Words to Know

boil	sap
drill	spout
maple syrup	tap



This is my family.
Every March, we make **maple syrup**.



Real maple syrup comes from
maple **sap**.
Sap is the juice in trees.
It's sort of like the blood in us.



March is a good time to get the sap.
It's still cold outside, but we wear our
boots and hats.
We go out to the woods behind my
grandparents' home.
We look for maple trees.



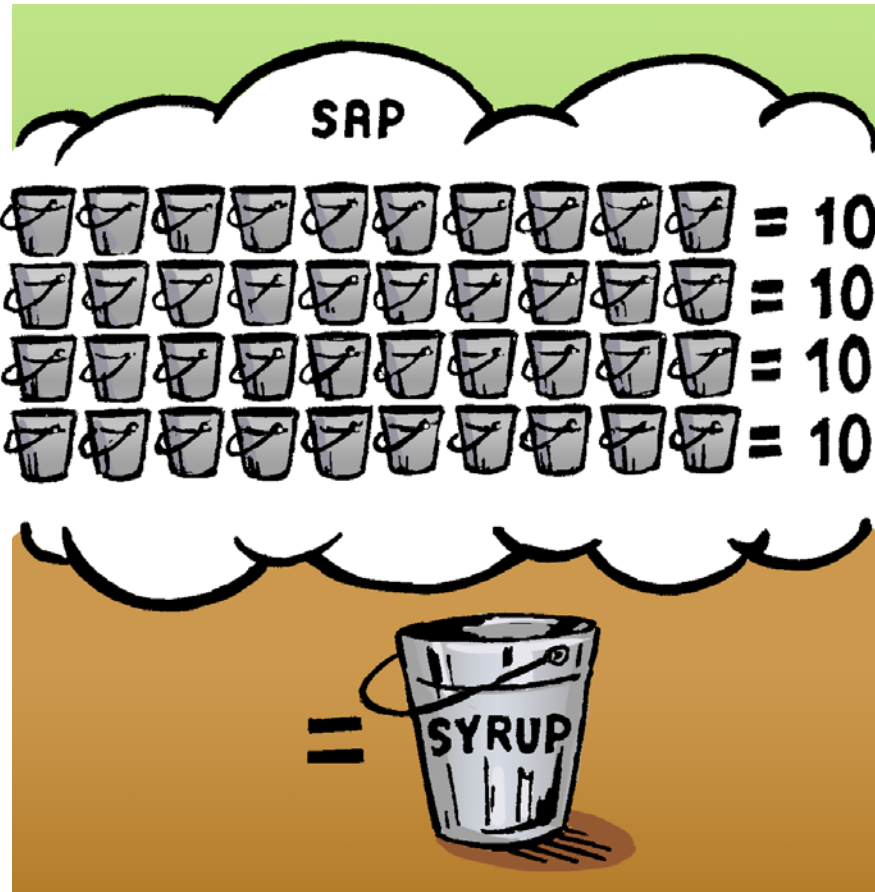
To **tap** a tree, we **drill** a hole.



We push a **spout** in the hole.
Then we hang a bucket under it
to get the sap.
We tap the big trees.
Big trees have the most sap.



We wait for the first drip. *Ping!*
One more drip, and we're on to the
next tree.



All that day, we let the sap drip.
Before dark, we look into our buckets.
We have a lot of sap, but we
want more.
Forty buckets of sap boil down to
make one bucket of syrup!



The next day, we look again.
Now we have what we want.



We **boil** the sap outside in two large pans.
It boils for hours, giving off a sticky steam.
Now and then, we add more sap.



We let it boil some more.
It boils all day under a blue sky.
The sky grows dark.
The stars come out.



From outside, Grandma calls, “Time for dinner! Make those pancakes!”



We do.

The syrup cools while the pancakes cook.



At last, we get to eat!
The syrup takes work, but it's worth it.

Glossary

boil (v.) page 11
to heat a liquid until it bubbles

drill (v.) page 6
to make a hole with a tool

maple syrup (n.) page 3
a sweet syrup made from the sap
of maple trees

sap (n.) page 4
the fluid that carries food through
a plant

spout (n.) page 7
a tube, pipe, or hole that allows
liquid to pass through

tap (v.) page 6
to make a hole in something to
drain off liquid